Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣7

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣10

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥5

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5
♥ A K 10 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6

♠ 10 9 7 3
♥ 4
♦ Q 10 4 2
♣ A Q 10 3



♠ Q J 6
♥ 9 2
♦ J 5
♣ K 8 7 5 4 2

♠ A 8 4 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 9 8 6 3
♣ —

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			

7♥ by North
Lead: ♦J

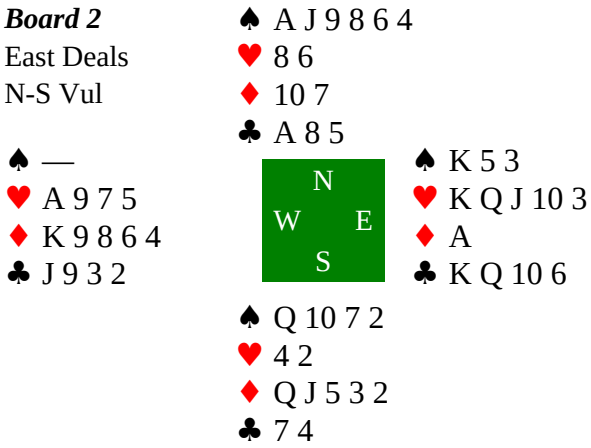
SOUTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

NORTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

SOUTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

NORTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣7

EAST figures that if WEST holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

WEST only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

EAST manages to figure out that WEST has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K 7 5 3
♥ J 8 7
♦ A 8 6 5
♣ 7 4

♠ Q J
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K 10 9 4
♣ 10 9 8



♠ 10 2
♥ 5 4 2
♦ Q J 3 2
♣ A Q 5 2

♠ A 9 8 6 4
♥ A K Q
♦ 7
♣ K J 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣10

SOUTH may have a good hand but NORTH merely gave a simple raise. Even if NORTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K J 8 6 ♥ 5 ♦ Q 9 7 6 3 ♣ 10 8 2	
♠ — ♥ K Q J 8 6 3 ♦ K J 2 ♣ A Q 6 5		♠ Q 7 5 3 ♥ 10 9 4 2 ♦ A 8 ♣ K J 4
	♠ A 10 9 4 2 ♥ A 7 ♦ 10 5 4 ♣ 9 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♥5

WEST has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and EAST shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that EAST holds the ♦A, he bids 6♥, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!